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SANZA, a characteristic feature of Zande language and thought

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(7) *Gude a ri ga bako kondo mbiko badia bako* 'a child has eaten his father's hen on account of his father's friend'. Comment: 'In the past an elder did not eat a hen with his son in any circumstances. It is that when his friend arrived and he cooked a hen for his friend, his friend called the son of this owner of the homestead to come and eat it with him. The child's father said "you eat first and then I will give what is left over to the child". His friend would not give way and the child came and sat down to eat the hen with his father's friend. It is about that that he spoke this *sanza*.'

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(8) *I na yugo nga sanza fu awiri ira sanza te* 'they do not teach a *sanza* to the children of a person who knows it'. Comment: 'The meaning of this is that a man should not try and teach a prince *sanza*, because it was the princes who originated *sanza*. Princes tell Azande not to teach them *sanza*, who are princes, because it was they who started *sanza*.'

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(9) *Anyogi na batika zi* 'a bee has begotten a fly'. Comment: 'A man begets many children and he watches them carefully all the time and he sees that one of them is stupid and he says "the bee gave birth to a fly". For the bee is a courageous insect and one not to be trifled with. It is that this outstanding

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man has begotten children who are not all alert as he is.' (Fr. Bervoets gives:
nioge vungi azi 'de bie heeft vliegen gebaard'.)

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(10) *I ni kpe miri bi anga kina ngba ru yo* 'they rub the black dog's dung in its own mouth'. Comment: 'This means that they do not kill a man on account of what another has done, only on account of what he himself has done. If a man has done ill they do not say on account of that man who always goes about with him that it is good to act as though that friend of his had done the ill.' (If the black dog steals things they kill it, and not the red dog.)

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(11) *Bamongo yo na nye nga ko o gbua te* 'a man does not go on laughing for no reason'. Comment: 'If a man is smiling he has had a good meal and is satisfied; laughter appeals to you then. If you are hungry or sick, laughter altogether leaves your lips; if a man jokes  208 then, it does not at all please you. Therefore people speak this *sanza*, saying that there is no laughter without a cause.'

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